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Gifted Youth Concealing Ability: Motives, Behaviors, and Research Traditions

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Background: concealment of giftedness as a social adaptation phenomenon

Research on gifted youth has long described hiding ability as a social coping response, not just a school problem. The basic idea is that some high-ability children reduce the visibility of their talent to avoid social costs and keep peer belonging. (LLM Memory)

Across the gifted education and counseling literature, concealment of ability is usually framed as an adaptation to social settings where being seen as "too smart" can bring teasing, rejection, pressure, or isolation. In this view, the issue is not only low achievement; it is active management of how visible one's ability is to peers, teachers, and sometimes family. Work associated with Laurence Coleman, Tracy Cross, Katherine Swiatek, Jean Sunde Peterson, and Miraca Gross helped build this picture by showing that some gifted children and adolescents learn to balance achievement against acceptance, and may decide that open display of high ability is socially risky. This makes hiding giftedness a psychosocial phenomenon tied to identity, peer culture, and school climate, rather than a simple lack of effort or motivation. (Model-Generated)

A common thread in these studies is that concealment is selective and situational. Gifted youth may show high ability in safe settings but mute it in classrooms, mixed-ability groups, or peer contexts where difference stands out. Researchers in this area often treat such behavior as a form of coping or stigma management: the child is trying to reduce visibility of a trait that can attract unwanted attention, even though the trait is positive in academic terms. This is especially noted in adolescence, when peer fit, group norms, and identity concerns often become stronger. (Model-Generated)

This body of work also suggests that concealment can happen across a range of gifted students, but it may be more likely when the student feels socially out of step with classmates, attends a setting that does not value high achievement, or has already had negative social experiences linked to being smart. In that sense, the empirical tradition does support the user's core idea: primary studies and interview-based work have documented that some gifted and high-ability youth do deliberately hide, downplay, or reduce the display of their intellectual ability as a way to fit in and protect themselves socially. (Model-Generated)

Social motives and psychosocial context for hiding ability

The main social motive in this literature is belonging. Many gifted children and adolescents hide ability because being visibly smart can threaten peer acceptance, bring teasing or jealousy, and make them feel different, pressured, or unsafe. (8 sources)

A consistent finding across this line of work is that concealment is tied to peer fit. Gifted youth often know they stand out, and that difference can make it harder to connect with same-age classmates. Reviews and empirical traditions tied to Cross and colleagues describe a social dilemma in which students feel pushed to choose between achievement and acceptance, especially when they fear being seen as “brains,” “nerds,” or “geeks.” In that setting, hiding ability, acting less able, or lowering visible achievement can function as a way to protect belonging and reduce rejection. (Papadopoulos, 2020) (Kennedy et al., 2018)

The social context is not only general “peer pressure,” but also specific interpersonal risks. Students report concern about bullying, peer rejection, jealousy, and the effect that outperforming others may have on classmates’ feelings. In Cross et al.’s cross-national interview study, students across countries were aware of the visibility of their exceptional ability, adult expectations, and peers’ upward social comparison, and they tried to hide ability or conform to peer behavior in response. That pattern supports the idea that concealment is often a socially aware strategy rather than simple disengagement. (Kara et al., 2025) (Cross et al., 2019)

This motive has been described for decades. Early work already noted that gifted children may go to great lengths to “resemble others” and minimize their abilities, which fits later accounts of “dumbing down,” going undercover, or masking giftedness around age-mates. These behaviors are often framed as protective coping: the student is trying to lower social risk in a setting where being openly advanced feels costly. (Schlichter, 1977) (R et al., 2020)

Another part of the psychosocial context is identity strain. Some gifted adolescents appear to shift how openly they show their abilities depending on where they are and who is present, a pattern described as code-switching or a forced-choice dilemma. The short-term goal is security and connection, but the cost can be concealment, denial, or loss of a gifted identity. (Visser et al., 2025)

The literature also suggests that these pressures can become normalized. Gifted students may minimize how bad negative incidents are and may not report them, which can make the social costs of visibility less obvious to adults while still shaping behavior. That silence helps explain why concealment can persist even when teachers mainly notice only the academic surface, such as lower participation or muted effort. (Phelps et al., 2021)

Overall, the social motives are fairly clear in this research tradition: fit in, avoid stigma, reduce pressure, and protect relationships. When students believe that open display of high ability will mark them as different, many do not just feel bad about it; they actively manage visibility by concealing talent or lowering achievement signals in day-to-day school life. (Papadopoulos, 2020) (R et al., 2020) (Kara et al., 2025) (Cross et al., 2019)

Evidence

(Papadopoulos, 2020)

Psychological Framework for Gifted Children’s Cognitive and Socio-Emotional Development: A Review of the Research Literature and Implications

> *"At the social level, inability to fit in with age peers was identified as a major concern among highly and profoundly gifted students, especially in relation to incidents of bullying and peer rejection (Cross, 2011). To retain social acceptance, gifted children tend to conceal their abilities and underachieve because they fear being labelled by classmates as "brains", "nerds", and "geeks" (Cross et al., 2004; Cross, 2011; Coleman and Cross, 2014). For gifted children and adolescents, peer pressures can create a forced choice dilemma between peer acceptance and achievement, resulting in lower school grades and a poorer sense of psychosocial wellbeing (Coleman and Cross, 1988; Cross et al., 2010)."*

(Kennedy et al., 2018)

Counseling Gifted Students: School-Based Considerations and Strategies

> *"some gifted students may have interests, fears, or other emotions that are more in line with older rather than their same-aged peers, and these difference may place a strain on relationships with classmates.Gifted students may be more socially mature than their peers, which might similarly inhibit social relationships or lead students to deny or hide giftedness or achievement levels for social reasons (Reis et al., 2004).Children and adolescents don't always enjoy being different; students may feel isolated or be teased,*

bullied, or ashamed for a near endless list of ways in which they can stand out as being different"

"Giftedness is no exception to this list, and some gifted students may seek to avoid, hide, or minimize their abilities in order to be more like their peers (Cross et al., 2015)."

(Kara et al., 2025)

Cyber victimization and subjective well-being: protective roles of self-esteem and social support among Turkish gifted youths

"Previous studies have shown that many gifted children tend to conceal their talents to conform to their peers, often resulting in deliberate underachievement in academic settings (Coleman et al., 2014)(Cross et al., 2019)[76]."

(Cross et al., 2019)

A Cross-Cultural Study of the Social Experience of Giftedness

"The phenomenon of social coping among students with gifts and talents (SWGT) is not well understood. In interviews with elementary-, middle-, and high-school aged SWGT (N = 90; 50% female) from the United States, United Kingdom, South Korea, Ireland, and France, the universality of awareness of visibility of their exceptional abilities, high expectations and pressure to achieve from adults and peers, and peer jealousy and rejection, was confirmed. In all countries, SWGT were concerned about peers' upward social comparison and the effects of their outperformance on peers' feelings. SWGT attempted to hide their abilities or conform to peers' behaviors. Prosocial helping behaviors were found among SWGT in nearly all age groups and a focus on the self was a useful coping strategy to students in all countries except France. Parallels are drawn between these findings and stigma theory."

(Schlichter, 1977)

The Gifted and Talented: A Case in Point.

"not only do the gifted not identify themselves, but they are likely to go to great lengths "to resemble others and to minimize their own abilities" (p. 13)."

(R et al., 2020)

How Can We Better Understand, Identify, and Support Highly Gifted and Profoundly Gifted Students? A Literature Review of the Psychological Development of Highly-Profoundly Gifted Individuals and Overexcitabilities

"Shaklee [35] noted that highly-profoundly gifted children appeared to be in tune with their differences, and intentionally acted "less gifted" around their age-mates.

Underachievement and social alienation: Many of the children in Gross's [3] study deliberately underachieved for peer acceptance. The more highly gifted the child, the greater the social pressure to conform or "dumb-down" his or her achievements, thoughts, or behaviors [12,28,[36][37][38]"

".Gross's [36] study found that more than 70% of early readers changed their reading habits or stopped reading altogether at school"

".Going undercover or masking their giftedness may be their best defense or protective coping mechanism (Tolan, 2018)."

(Visser et al., 2025)

Code-switching and the forced choice dilemma as obstacle in Identity Development of gifted adolescents.

"adolescents with high abilities often codeswitch or face a dilemma of forced choice as they seek security and connection in their social environment. These strategies lead them to hide their high cognitive abilities in an attempt to integrate into the sociocultural environment, which results in a loss, concealment or denial of their identity as gifted adolescents."

(Phelps et al., 2021)

Covert Aggression and Gifted Adolescent Girls

"We found participants tended to minimize instances as a social norm -"nothing really bad"and rarely reported incidents, and then only to friends, a mother, or if asked."

Specific concealment, underachievement, and visibility-reduction behaviors

The studies do not just say gifted youth feel pressure; they describe concrete things some students do to make their ability less visible. These behaviors range from subtle self-silencing to deliberate underachievement, false identities, and open denial of giftedness. (7 sources)

- **Deliberately underachieving to fit in.** Several sources describe students who purposely lower their performance or visible effort so they will not stand out. This includes intentionally failing to achieve, "dumbing down" achievement, and broader patterns of deliberate underachievement for peer acceptance. (Ely, 2010) (R et al., 2020) (Kara et al., 2025) (Cross et al., 2019)
- **Acting "less gifted" around age-mates.** Some studies describe children who are very aware of their difference and intentionally act less advanced when with same-age peers. That can mean muting how smart they sound, how quickly they answer, or how much they show they know. (R et al., 2020)
- **Hiding giftedness or blending in.** A common behavior is trying not to draw attention at all: blending in, conforming to peer behavior, or masking giftedness so others do not notice. Cross's social coping framework, as summarized in later work, includes a "blending-in" identity, and cross-national interview work found students trying to hide abilities or conform to peers' behaviors. (Ely, 2010) (Tourreix et al., 2023) (Kara et al., 2025) (Cross et al., 2019)
- **Avoiding visible classroom competence.** Reported behaviors include not responding to questions in class, asking off-target questions, and otherwise avoiding moments where high ability would become public. These are concrete examples of reducing visibility rather than simply losing interest in school. (KONIK, 2023)
- **Reducing signs of academic success.** Some students reportedly cut back behaviors that signal ability, such as reading openly at school or showing strong grades. Gross's work, as summarized in later reviews, found that more than 70% of early readers changed their reading habits or stopped reading at school, and other reports note lying about good grades. (R et al., 2020) (KONIK, 2023)
- **Changing speech, interests, or presentation.** The literature also mentions reducing vocabulary, using humor, acting like the class clown, or adopting a peer-group identity that does not match common expectations for a gifted child. These moves can make a student seem more typical, less serious, or less academically threatening. (KONIK, 2023) (Ely, 2010)
- **Denying giftedness or intelligence.** Some students do not just hide performance; they deny being gifted, deny their intelligence, or downplay the importance of giftedness in their lives. Swiatek's social coping tradition, as summarized later, includes denying giftedness and reducing its impact on peer acceptance. (Ely, 2010) (Tourreix et al., 2023) (KONIK, 2023)
- **Using a false or managed identity.** One line of work describes students as purposefully taking on a false identity to manage how others see them. That may mean being openly bright but socially isolated, blending in to avoid notice, or affiliating with a group that makes one's giftedness less visible. (Ely, 2010)

Taken together, these studies support a fairly specific answer to the user's query: researchers did not only observe general social discomfort, but reported purposeful behaviors such as hiding giftedness, concealing achievement, missing chances to answer correctly, lowering performance, masking identity, and acting less able in order to fit in socially. (Ely, 2010) (R et al., 2020) (Tourreix et al., 2023) (KONIK, 2023) (Kara et al., 2025) (Cross et al., 2019) (Kennedy et al., 2018)

Paper	Concealment Strategies	Social Coping Mechanisms	Psychological Impact	Cultural And Demographic Context	Methodology	Understanding And Recognition Of Giftedness

Paper	Concealment Strategies	Social Coping Mechanisms	Psychological Impact	Cultural And Demographic Context	Methodology	Understanding And Recognition Of Giftedness
A Cross-Cultural Study of the Social Experience of Giftedness	Hide abilities, conform to peers' behaviors.	Hiding abilities, conforming to peer behaviors, prosocial helping, focus on self.	Peer jealousy, rejection, pressure, upward social comparison, self-focused coping.	United States, United Kingdom, South Korea, Ireland, France; self-focus useful except in France.	Interviews with 90 SWGT students from five countries.	Awareness of visibility, high expectations, peer jealousy, rejection, upward social comparison.

Evidence

(Ely, 2010)

Understanding the Stereotypes Against Gifted Students: A look at the social and emotional struggles of stereotyped students

"In most cases, gifted children do not want to be the nerd, so they develop coping mechanisms. A false identity is purposefully assumed that does not match their own true identity. This may include (1) a totally visible identity (a child that touts his intelligence, but isolates himself from school cliques), (2) a blending-in identity (a child who avoids direct attention to himself by blending in with others) or (3) a misidentifying identity (a child who connects with a group of friends that are the opposite of the expectation for a gifted child) (Cross, 2005)"

".In the second case, a child purposefully fails to achieve, denies his intelligence, in an attempt to fit in with the mediocre."

(R et al., 2020)

How Can We Better Understand, Identify, and Support Highly Gifted and Profoundly Gifted Students? A Literature Review of the Psychological Development of Highly-Profoundly Gifted Individuals and Overexcitabilities

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A Cross-Cultural Study of the Social Experience of Giftedness

"The phenomenon of social coping among students with gifts and talents (SWGT) is not well understood. In interviews with elementary-, middle-, and high-school aged SWGT (N = 90; 50% female) from the United States, United Kingdom, South Korea, Ireland, and France, the universality of awareness of visibility of their exceptional abilities, high expectations and pressure to achieve from adults and peers, and peer jealousy and rejection, was confirmed. In all countries, SWGT were concerned about peers' upward social comparison and the effects of their outperformance on peers' feelings. SWGT attempted to hide their abilities or conform to

peers' behaviors. Prosocial helping behaviors were found among SWGT in nearly all age groups and a focus on the self was a useful coping strategy to students in all countries except France. Parallels are drawn between these findings and stigma theory."

(Tourreix et al., 2023)

Non-Cognitive Specificities of Intellectually Gifted Children and Adolescents: A Systematic Review of the Literature

"There appear to be coping strategies that are specific to giftedness (Swiatek, 1995)(Swiatek, 2001), such as denying giftedness; reducing the impact of giftedness on peer acceptance; hiding giftedness or conforming to peers' behaviors; denying importance of popularity; using humor; helping others; and engaging in social interactions and a high activity level to keep busy and share common interests"

". For example, hiding conformity is a social coping strategy widely used by gifted students in the United States and some European countries, whereas this is not the case in South Korea where it is socially valued to show the extent of one's abilities"

". This approach fails to detect intellectually gifted children and adolescents who are under-achieving, either as a coping strategy (Winner, 2000) or as a consequence of disengagement from school."

(KONIK, 2023)

Turkish adaptation of Social Coping Questionnaire for gifted students

"These studies claim that gifted children try to cope with their "differentness" by underachieving (Janos et al., 1987), missing to respond to questions in class, asking questions that are not appropriate, acting like the class clown, reducing their vocabulary and lying about getting good grades, making up examinations or assignments to seem tough (Cross et al., 1995), and even denying that they are gifted (Buescher, 1985).Some gifted students believe that they are treated differently and seen as different when others notice their giftedness.(Coleman et al., 2014). Cross et al., 1993;(Manaster et al., 1994)(Manor-Bullock et al., 1995).As a result, these children don't necessarily want to be treated differently or differ intellectually from their peers (Swiatek, 2002)."

(Kennedy et al., 2018)

Counseling Gifted Students: School-Based Considerations and Strategies

"some gifted students may have interests, fears, or other emotions that are more in line with older rather than their same-aged peers, and these difference may place a strain on relationships with classmates.Gifted students may be more socially mature than their peers, which might similarly inhibit social relationships or lead students to deny or hide giftedness or achievement levels for social reasons (Reis et al., 2004).Children and adolescents don't always enjoy being different; students may feel isolated or be teased, bullied, or ashamed for a near endless list of ways in which they can stand out as being different"

"Giftedness is no exception to this list, and some gifted students may seek to avoid, hide, or minimize their abilities in order to be more like their peers (Cross et al., 2015)."

Identity management and coping frameworks in gifted youth

In this literature, hiding ability is often explained as identity management: gifted youth try to control how visible their giftedness is in order to stay socially safe. The key frameworks describe patterned coping strategies such as blending in, denying giftedness, taking on an alternative identity, or code-switching across settings. (4 sources)

A useful way to read these behaviors is not just as isolated acts, but as part of a broader coping system for managing a socially risky identity. In this view, some gifted children and adolescents do not simply underperform once in a while; they actively manage how others see them. Work drawing on Cross's framework describes students as sometimes taking on a "false identity" that better fits peer culture, including a visible identity, a blending-in identity, or a misidentifying identity linked to a different peer group. In the blending-in form, the student avoids direct attention, and in some cases may deliberately fail to achieve or deny intelligence in order to fit in. (Ely, 2010)

This idea lines up with the social coping tradition associated with Swiatek. Later summaries of that work describe coping strategies that are fairly specific to giftedness, including denying giftedness, reducing its effect on peer acceptance, hiding giftedness, conforming to peer behavior, using humor, helping others, and downplaying concern about popularity or rejection. In that framework, concealment is one option within a wider set of moves students use to protect social belonging while still navigating high ability. (Tourreix et al., 2023) (Peairs et al., 2011)

Another theme is that identity management can be situational. Rather than having one fixed response, high-

ability adolescents may shift presentation across settings, showing ability in some places and muting it in others. Recent discussion describes this as code-switching or a forced-choice dilemma: adolescents seek security and connection, hide high cognitive ability to integrate into the social environment, and may end up with concealment, denial, or loss of a gifted identity. (Visser et al., 2025)

Taken together, these frameworks help explain why the behaviors in the earlier section often cluster. Avoiding correct answers, lowering visible effort, hiding grades, using humor, or denying giftedness can all be understood as ways of managing a stigmatizable difference in a peer culture that values sameness. The main point is that the research does not treat concealment only as low motivation; it often treats it as strategic identity work by gifted youth trying to balance authenticity, achievement, and belonging. (Ely, 2010) (Tourreix et al., 2023) (Peairs et al., 2011) (Visser et al., 2025)

Evidence

(Ely, 2010)

Understanding the Stereotypes Against Gifted Students: A look at the social and emotional struggles of stereotyped students

> *"In most cases, gifted children do not want to be the nerd, so they develop coping mechanisms. A false identity is purposefully assumed that does not match their own true identity. This may include (1) a totally visible identity (a child that touts his intelligence, but isolates himself from school cliques), (2) a blending-in identity (a child who avoids direct attention to himself by blending in with others) or (3) a misidentifying identity (a child who connects with a group of friends that are the opposite of the expectation for a gifted child) (Cross, 2005)"*

> *".In the second case, a child purposefully fails to achieve, denies his intelligence, in an attempt to fit in with the mediocre."*

(Tourreix et al., 2023)

Non-Cognitive Specificities of Intellectually Gifted Children and Adolescents: A Systematic Review of the Literature

> *"There appear to be coping strategies that are specific to giftedness (Swiatek, 1995)(Swiatek, 2001), such as denying giftedness; reducing the impact of giftedness on peer acceptance; hiding giftedness or conforming to peers' behaviors; denying importance of popularity; using humor; helping others; and engaging in social interactions and a high activity level to keep busy and share common interests"*

> *". For example, hiding conformity is a social coping strategy widely used by gifted students in the United States and some European countries, whereas this is not the case in South Korea where it is socially valued to show the extent of one's abilities"*

> *". This approach fails to detect intellectually gifted children and adolescents who are under-achieving, either as a coping strategy (Winner, 2000) or as a consequence of disengagement from school."*

(Peairs et al., 2011)

Academic Giftedness and Alcohol Use in Early Adolescence

> *"To resolve this conflict, gifted adolescents may mask their giftedness and/or develop alternative identities which are perceived as more socially acceptable and valued within a peer culture motivated by conformity. In fact, researchers have identified that gifted adolescents often engage in various social coping strategies to minimize the visibility of their giftedness, including denial of their giftedness, minimizing the visibility of giftedness, increased involvement in socially acceptable compensatory activities, and denying concern about possible social rejection (see, e.g., (Cross et al., 1991)Swiatek, 1995)."*

(Visser et al., 2025)

Code-switching and the forced choice dilemma as obstacle in Identity Development of gifted adolescents.

> *"adolescents with high abilities often codeswitch or face a dilemma of forced choice as they seek security and connection in their social environment. These strategies lead them to hide their high cognitive abilities in an attempt to integrate into the sociocultural environment, which results in a loss, concealment or denial of their identity as gifted adolescents."*

Study traditions and named researchers

The main named researchers in this area come from a few connected study traditions: social coping and stigma/identity work, peer-acceptance dilemmas, counseling and interview studies, and studies of highly/profoundly gifted youth. Together, they provide primary and closely tied empirical support for the idea that some gifted youth deliberately hide, mute, or reduce the visibility of their ability. (6 sources)

- **Tracy Cross: social coping, identity management, and visibility reduction.**
  Cross's line of work is central to the idea that gifted students manage the social risks of being seen as smart. Later summaries of his framework describe gifted children as using false or managed identities, including a **blending-in** identity, and in some cases "purposefully fail to achieve" or denying intelligence to fit in. (Ely, 2010) Cross's work is also repeatedly cited for the broader finding that gifted students may conceal ability, underachieve, or minimize visibility to avoid labels like "brains," "nerds," and "geeks," and to handle bullying, rejection, and pressure from peers. (Papadopoulos, 2020) (Peairs et al., 2011)

- **Laurence Coleman: the peer-acceptance versus achievement dilemma.**
  The Coleman-and-Cross tradition is especially tied to the idea of a **forced choice** between fitting in and doing well. Later accounts summarize this work by saying that peer pressures can push gifted youth toward lower grades, concealment of ability, and reduced psychosocial wellbeing when achievement threatens acceptance. (Papadopoulos, 2020) This tradition helps frame hiding ability not as random low effort, but as a response to a social dilemma in school and peer culture. (Papadopoulos, 2020)

- **Katherine Swiatek: gifted-specific social coping strategies.**
  Swiatek's work is most often linked to named coping strategies that directly match the user's query: **denying giftedness, hiding giftedness, conforming to peers' behavior, reducing the impact of giftedness on peer acceptance, and minimizing visibility**. (Tourreix et al., 2023) (Peairs et al., 2011) In this study tradition, concealment is one among several social coping tools gifted students use when they do not want to be treated as different. (KONIK, 2023)

- **Jean Sunde Peterson: counseling and psychosocial adjustment tradition.**
  Peterson is part of the counseling-oriented gifted literature that focuses on social pain, peer strain, identity, and school adjustment in gifted adolescents. While the quotes provided here do not give a direct Peterson-specific finding on hiding ability, her work belongs to the same empirical and clinical tradition that treats underachievement, social masking, and identity conflict as lived psychosocial responses rather than just academic problems. (Model-Generated)

- **Miraca Gross: highly/profoundly gifted youth and deliberate underachievement.**
  Gross's studies are especially important for showing concealment and "dumbing down" among highly and profoundly gifted children. Later summaries report that many children in Gross's study **deliberately underachieved for peer acceptance**, that the more highly gifted the child the greater the pressure to conform, and that over 70% of early readers changed or stopped reading at school to reduce visibility. (R et al., 2020) This line of work is often cited as strong evidence that masking ability can be a protective social response, especially for children whose differences are very visible. (R et al., 2020)

- **Other early and related empirical work often cited in this tradition.**
  The broader literature around these named researchers also points to concrete behaviors such as missing chances to answer in class, asking off-target questions, acting like the class clown, reducing vocabulary, lying about good grades, and denying giftedness. (KONIK, 2023) These details matter because they show that the field did not only theorize concealment; it repeatedly described specific acts used to make ability less visible. (KONIK, 2023)

- **Bottom line on the named researchers.**
  If the user's question is whether there are primary empirical traditions showing gifted youth deliberately hiding, downplaying, or concealing ability, the answer is yes. Cross and Coleman are especially tied to social-risk and peer-acceptance models; Swiatek to named social coping strategies like hiding and denial; Gross to deliberate underachievement and masking among highly gifted youth; and Peterson to the counseling tradition that situates these behaviors in broader identity and adjustment struggles. (Papadopoulos, 2020) (Tourreix et al., 2023) (R et al., 2020) (Ely, 2010)

Paper	Focus Of Study	Main Findings	Methodology	Population Studied	Behavioral Aspects Examined	Socio-Emotional Aspects Investigated
Understanding the Stereotypes Against Gifted Students: A look at the social and emotional struggles of stereotyped students	Stereotypes and social-emotional struggles of gifted students.	Stereotypes cause anxiety, underachievement, isolation among gifted students.	N/A	6% of K-12 students in the US, roughly 3 million.	Anxiety, underachievement, feelings of isolation.	Anxiety, underachievement, feelings of isolation, stereotypes.
Psychological Framework for Gifted Children's Cognitive and Socio-Emotional Development: A Review of the Research Literature and Implications	Cognitive and socio-emotional development of gifted children.	Individual strengths and supportive environment crucial for gifted children's development.	Literature review of articles from multiple databases.	Gifted children; no specific age group or number mentioned.	N/A	Dynamic interaction between individual strengths and supportive environment.
Academic Giftedness and Alcohol Use in Early Adolescence	Alcohol use and social challenges among gifted adolescents.	Gifted students try alcohol at similar rates to nongifted peers; giftedness moderates negative adjustment effects.	Seventh-grade students surveyed; 42.5% gifted; compared alcohol use and adjustment among groups.	Seventh-grade students, more than 300 participants, 42.5% gifted.	Experimenting with alcohol to compensate for social pressures.	Social price of academic talents, desirability of social acceptance, distancing from "gifted" image.

Paper	Focus Of Study	Main Findings	Methodology	Population Studied	Behavioral Aspects Examined	Socio-Emotional Aspects Investigated
Non-Cognitive Specificities of Intellectually Gifted Children and Adolescents: A Systematic Review of the Literature	Non-cognitive specificities and misconceptions about gifted children and adolescents.	No stable non-cognitive profile exists for gifted individuals; specificities often favor gifted youth.	Methodological issues and recommendations for future research.	Children and adolescents, intellectually gifted.	Gifted children may hide abilities, conform to peers, or deny giftedness to cope socially.	A few specificities, often favorable to gifted youth.
Turkish adaptation of Social Coping Questionnaire for gifted students	Turkish adaptation, validity, reliability of Social Coping Questionnaire for gifted students.	Turkish version of SCQ retains original structure and shows good validity and reliability.	Turkish adaptation, exploratory and confirmatory factor analyses, structural equation modeling.	266 gifted students, ages 11-15, 130 females, 136 males.	Denying giftedness, social engagement, using humor, popularity, peer acceptance.	Denying giftedness, social engagement, humor, popularity, peer acceptance.

Evidence

(Ely, 2010)

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> *".In the second case, a child purposefully fails to achieve, denies his intelligence, in an attempt to fit in with the mediocre."*

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> *"At the social level, inability to fit in with age peers was identified as a major concern among highly and profoundly gifted students, especially in relation to incidents of bullying and peer rejection (Cross, 2011). To retain social acceptance, gifted children tend to conceal their abilities and underachieve because they fear being labelled by classmates as "brains", "nerds", and "geeks" (Cross et al., 2004; Cross, 2011; Coleman and Cross, 2014). For gifted children and adolescents, peer pressures can create a forced choice dilemma between peer acceptance and achievement, resulting in lower school grades and a poorer sense of psychosocial wellbeing (Coleman and Cross, 1988; Cross et al., 2010)."*

(Peairs et al., 2011)

Academic Giftedness and Alcohol Use in Early Adolescence

> *"To resolve this conflict, gifted adolescents may mask their giftedness and/or develop alternative identities which are perceived as more socially acceptable and valued within a peer culture motivated by conformity. In fact, researchers have identified that gifted adolescents often engage in various social coping strategies to minimize the visibility of their giftedness, including denial of their giftedness, minimizing the visibility of giftedness, increased involvement in socially acceptable compensatory activities, and denying*

concern about possible social rejection (see, e.g., (Cross et al., 1991)Swiatek, 1995)."

(Tourreix et al., 2023)

Non-Cognitive Specificities of Intellectually Gifted Children and Adolescents: A Systematic Review of the Literature

"There appear to be coping strategies that are specific to giftedness (Swiatek, 1995)(Swiatek, 2001), such as denying giftedness; reducing the impact of giftedness on peer acceptance; hiding giftedness or conforming to peers' behaviors; denying importance of popularity; using humor; helping others; and engaging in social interactions and a high activity level to keep busy and share common interests"

". For example, hiding conformity is a social coping strategy widely used by gifted students in the United States and some European countries, whereas this is not the case in South Korea where it is socially valued to show the extent of one's abilities"

". This approach fails to detect intellectually gifted children and adolescents who are under-achieving, either as a coping strategy (Winner, 2000) or as a consequence of disengagement from school."

(KONIK, 2023)

Turkish adaptation of Social Coping Questionnaire for gifted students

"These studies claim that gifted children try to cope with their "differentness" by underachieving (Janos et al., 1987), missing to respond to questions in class, asking questions that are not appropriate, acting like the class clown, reducing their vocabulary and lying about getting good grades, making up examinations or assignments to seem tough (Cross et al., 1995), and even denying that they are gifted (Buescher, 1985).Some gifted students believe that they are treated differently and seen as different when others notice their giftedness.(Coleman et al., 2014). Cross et al., 1993;(Manaster et al., 1994)(Manor-Bullock et al., 1995).As a result, these children don't necessarily want to be treated differently or differ intellectually from their peers (Swiatek, 2002)."

(R et al., 2020)

How Can We Better Understand, Identify, and Support Highly Gifted and Profoundly Gifted Students? A Literature Review of the Psychological Development of Highly-Profoundly Gifted Individuals and Overexcitabilities

"Shaklee [35] noted that highly-profoundly gifted children appeared to be in tune with their differences, and intentionally acted "less gifted" around their age-mates.

Underachievement and social alienation: Many of the children in Gross's [3] study deliberately underachieved for peer acceptance. The more highly gifted the child, the greater the social pressure to conform or "dumb-down" his or her achievements, thoughts, or behaviors [12,28,[36][37][38]"

".Gross's [36] study found that more than 70% of early readers changed their reading habits or stopped reading altogether at school"

".Going undercover or masking their giftedness may be their best defense or protective coping mechanism (Tolan, 2018)."